

Lean progress; sysadmin harm

**DENSE GRADIENT
from failed episodes
+ harm bounded**

yes

Domain

Is there a
VERIFIABLE potential
finer than the
outcome?

yes

Is it
UN-GAMEABLE?
(cheapest maximizer
must solve task)

yes

Are intermediate
values REACHABLE?
(within-group
variance > 0)

no

No usable signal:
outcome-only
ceiling (intent)

τ^2 customer service

no

COMPLIANCE
COLLAPSE
(misaligned penalty)

Lean penalty arms

no

VACUOUS signal:
zero gradient
(unreachable)

SWE software repair